



Partly sunny 41/25 • Tomorrow: Mostly sunny 35/19 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, DECEMBER 21, 2024 • \$3



HEIKO REBSCH/DPA/AP

The incident in Magdeburg, which led to an arrest at the scene, recalled deadly attacks on German Christmas markets in 2016 and 2018.

Deadly scene jars an uneasy Germany

BY KARLA ADAM,
SOUAD MEKHENNET
AND MIKHAIL KLIMENTOV

A driver plowed a car into a crowd at a Christmas market Friday evening in Magdeburg, Germany, killing at least two people, an adult and a child, and injuring nearly 70.

The suspected driver, a 50-year-old man from Saudi Arabia, was arrested on the scene. He arrived in Germany in 2006 and

At least 2 dead, dozens hurt after a car plows into Christmas market

had worked as a doctor, local officials said.

Reiner Haseloff, the state premier of Saxony-Anhalt, told reporters that officials believed the man was a lone attacker and that

there wasn't "any further danger for the city."

A German official with knowledge of the investigation into the suspect told The Washington Post that police were searching the man's home, adding that there were suspicions he was under the influence of drugs at the time of the incident. The official, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss an open investigation, said the suspect was not known to authorities or previous-

ly suspected of extremism.

A second German official confirmed his name as Taleb al-Abdulmohsen and said he expressed anti-Islamic views and described himself as a dissident from Saudi Arabia.

According to the city's count, 15 people were seriously hurt in the incident, while 37 people were moderately injured and 16 were lightly injured. Police closed off the area around the market after

SEE GERMANY ON A11

Port towns seek limits on waves of cruise ships

Residents say industry brings unwelcome crowds, pollution

BY ANDREA SACHS

YORKTOWN, VA. — For now, the waterfront is a picture of serenity.

On a recent fall morning in this historic Tidewater town, two men quietly fished on the pier. A scuba diver emerged from the York River like a slick seal. A couple walked their dogs by a young man dressed like a Founding Father, and they didn't even yap at his tricorn hat.

Bob Hodson, who lives a few blocks away from the water, was picturing a different scene. As he gazed at the still harbor, he imagined a large cruise ship at anchor and a flotilla of tenders disgorging thousands of day-trippers on the shore. The visitors would board coaches for the nearby Virginia battlefields and Colonial Williamsburg, essentially turning the 17th-century settlement of about 220 residents into a bus depot.

This was a future that he could not — would not — accept.

"The cruise ship industry is so powerful," said Hodson, 65. "But we're going to eradicate them like any other invasive species."

Hodson, a semiretired senior technical expert at NASA, is a modern-day David. His Goliath? A billion-dollar cruise ship industry equipped with lobbyists and lawyers. The cruise industry says it forges symbiotic relationships with communities and brings

SEE CRUISES ON A14



CRAIG HUDSON FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

The Commanders' 15-person culinary staff prepares specialized menus to fit the dietary needs of pro athletes and "makes you feel like you're in a restaurant," sous chef Kendall Applewhite said.

Food for fuel and fine dining: Commanders get taste of both

Restaurant-trained chefs strive to provide team a culinary edge

BY NICKI JHABVALA

The first delivery arrives shortly before 6 a.m. and is dollied down the concrete stairs, past the pantry of pots and cookware and into the walk-in refrigerator amid a concert of knives chopping and metal spatulas clanging. It's a typical October morning at the Washington Commanders' headquarters in Ashburn, where players are in the throes of preparation for the Chicago Bears and beginning to trickle in for another day of work.

In the back wing of the facility, however, the prep started long ago. The Commanders' kitchen, led by executive chef Connor McGuire,

operates nearly 80 hours per week, churning through roughly 93,000 eggs per year and more than 200 pounds of meat in a single meal.

It's a vital operation for any professional sports team. But in Washington, where the finer things have lacked for much of the century, the Commanders' cuisine has been a consistent luxury for 12 seasons.

McGuire, chef de cuisine Brandon Laurent and sous chef Kendall Applewhite trained at restaurants that earn Michelin stars or James Beard Foundation honors, so Washington's 15-person culinary team functions much as a high-end establishment would, with plated

SEE COMMANDERS ON A8

House passes stripped bill to stop shutdown

MEASURE SENT TO SENATE WITH HOURS LEFT

Johnson's perceived missteps may imperil his gavel

BY JACOB BOGAGE
AND MARIANNA SOTOMAYOR

Congress appeared on the verge of narrowly preventing a government shutdown Friday night, as the House easily approved legislation to extend federal funding, sending the measure to the Senate as lawmakers raced to beat the stroke of midnight.

The bill, which passed the House 366 to 34 with one voting present, punts a funding deadline to March 14, sends \$110.4 billion to struggling farmers, and renews the massive agriculture and anti-poverty law known as the farm bill.

Lawmakers reached Friday's vote after a week of turmoil. Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) released a funding deal with Democrats on Tuesday that included provisions to lower prescription drug costs and curtail private-sector investment to China, but House Republicans — egged on by President-elect Donald Trump and his billionaire adviser Elon Musk — walked away from a deal on Wednesday.

That risked not only a govern-



CRAIG HUDSON FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

House Speaker Mike Johnson returns to his office after the House passed the bill on Friday.

ment shutdown, but also called into question Johnson's standing within his party; he must run to retain his speakership on Jan. 3, when a new Congress is seated.

In the Senate, the bill's passage is not in doubt, but the process could drag into the wee hours as

SEE CONGRESS ON A4

Lying low: Biden appeared to let GOP battle it out over spending. A4

Mixed bag: RFK deal is omitted, but Md. bridge funding survives. B1

GOP defiance of Trump could hint at challenges

He's rebuffed on debt limit demand, showing limits of narrow majority

BY MARIANNE LEVINE,
HANNAH KNOWLES
AND LIZ GOODWIN

President-elect Donald Trump's last-minute demands for a congressional funding package were rejected by dozens of Republicans this week, foreshadowing the legislative challenges he could face next year — even with unified GOP control.

Trump's role in sinking a bipartisan deal to fund the government — and his public insistence that any spending bill lift the debt

ceiling — led to a failed vote on the House floor Thursday evening. More than three dozen members of his own party voted against the deal he'd endorsed hours earlier. Lawmakers sent to the Senate a new bill Friday that would avert a government shutdown; the bill did not include Trump's debt limit demand.

The drama highlighted the limits Trump faces in bending his entire party to his will, as Republicans hold a narrow margin in the House and remain ideologically split over government spending.

"It's the most incongruous messaging to say: 'Don't vote for this bill, it's bloated spending. By the way, get rid of the debt ceiling so I can spend more,'" said Marc Short, who was director of

SEE TRUMP ON A5

These students must lock up their phones. It's not so easy.

Nationally, more schools ban devices to promote learning, mental health

BY KARINA ELWOOD

Masiah Short's cellphone logged nearly 11½ hours of screen time one day this fall. She received more than 700 notifications and spent more than four hours texting her friends and scrolling Instagram, some of it during the school day.

Later that week, her Northern Virginia high school banned the devices.

"I use my phone, like, a lot," Masiah said. "But for necessary reasons, like to text my family,

respond to friends, talk about school."

She is not alone. Many of the teens at Wakefield High School in Arlington have grown up looking to phones to navigate daily life. They are also in the midst of a movement by officials and educators to separate them — at least during school hours — from the devices.

"We use our phones for everything," 16-year-old Brianna Gilbert said. "I use it for directions to get places. I use it as my alarm clock. I use it as my notes or as a second screen to do my work."

"It's like an organ," junior Jamharie Price added.

The goal at Wakefield, and the growing number of schools across the country banning cellphones, has been twofold: to limit

SEE CELLPHONES ON A7

IN THE NEWS

It's the economy Swing-state voters who broke for Donald Trump have faith that the president-elect will make their financial lives better, a poll has found. A6

Optimism and concern Syrians in the United States are grappling with the implications of the end of the Assad regime. B1

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Progress on reparations could be thwarted by Donald Trump, advocates said. A3

THE WORLD

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U.S. diplomats met with Syria's new leader, whose \$10 million U.S. bounty was lifted. A11

THE ECONOMY

Some steelworkers say the U.S. Steel deal is the best hope for their jobs and their towns. A12
Starbucks baristas in Los Angeles, Chicago and Seattle began a five-day strike expected to spread from coast to coast during the holiday rush. A13

THE REGION

A student at George Mason University was arrested after allegedly telling an FBI informant of plans to attack the Israeli Consulate in New York. B1
The Montgomery County schools chief seeks \$285 million more for next year's budget. B1

STYLE

Selena Fox, purple priestess of Wicca in Wisconsin, has been promoting public paganism for 50 years. C1

SPORTS

Cold-weather football is usually the province of the NFL postseason. Bundle up for the College Football Playoff. D1

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